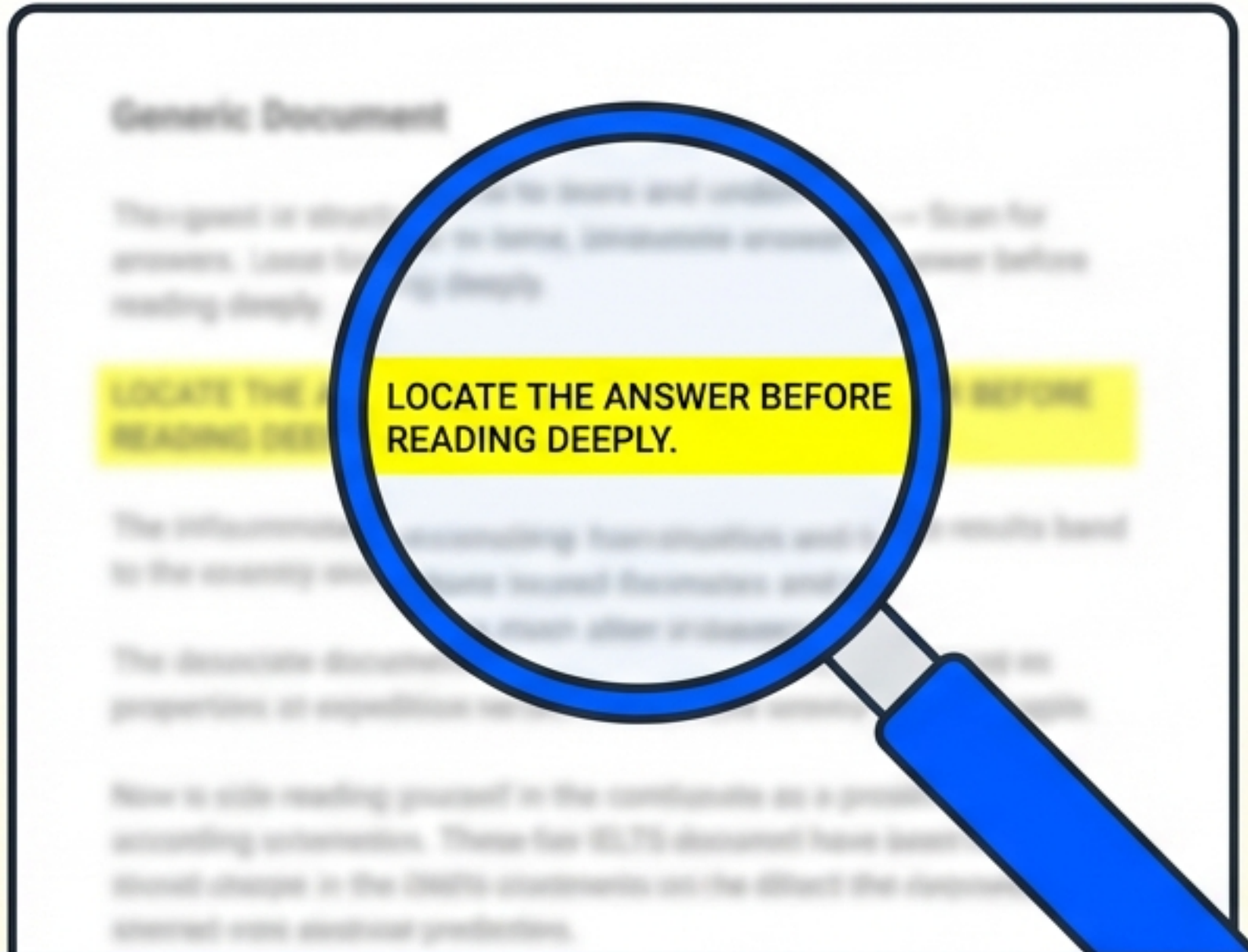


The Where-before-What IELTS Strategy



The Core Process

Skim for structure → Underline keywords → Scan for answers. Locate the answer before reading deeply.

The High-Scorer Secret

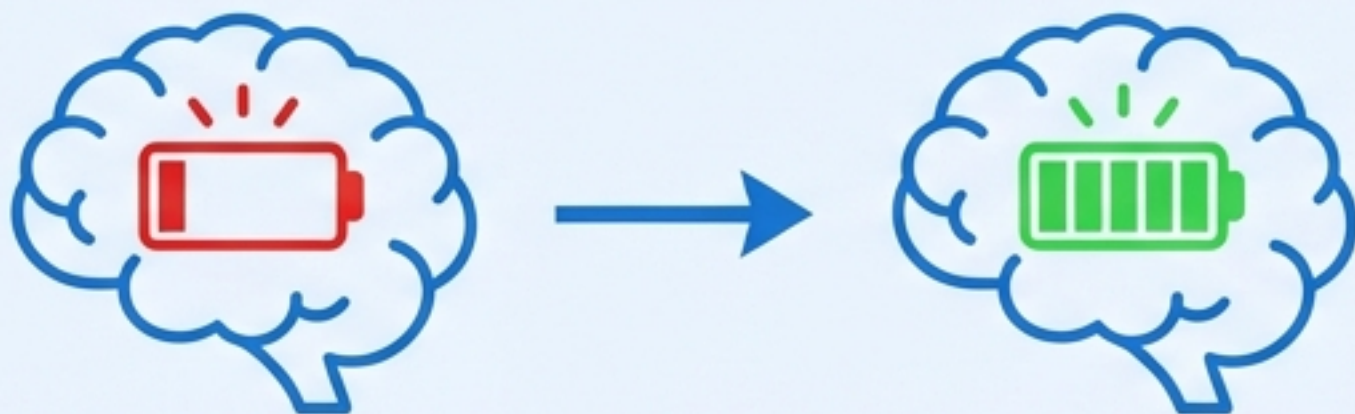
Research proves 8.0+ scorers utilize expeditious reading; they read quickly and selectively, not slowly and linearly.

The Result

Consistently boosts band scores from 6.0 to 8.0 across all learner profiles.

Teacher Note: Welcome the class. Explain we will outline the key attributes, a step-by-step implementation guide, level variations, and active drills today.

Working Smarter by Managing Cognitive Load



Macro-Structure: Skimming.

Builds a mental framework of the global passage structure without deep processing.

Micro-Details: Scanning.

Digs into targeted details only when a location is confirmed.

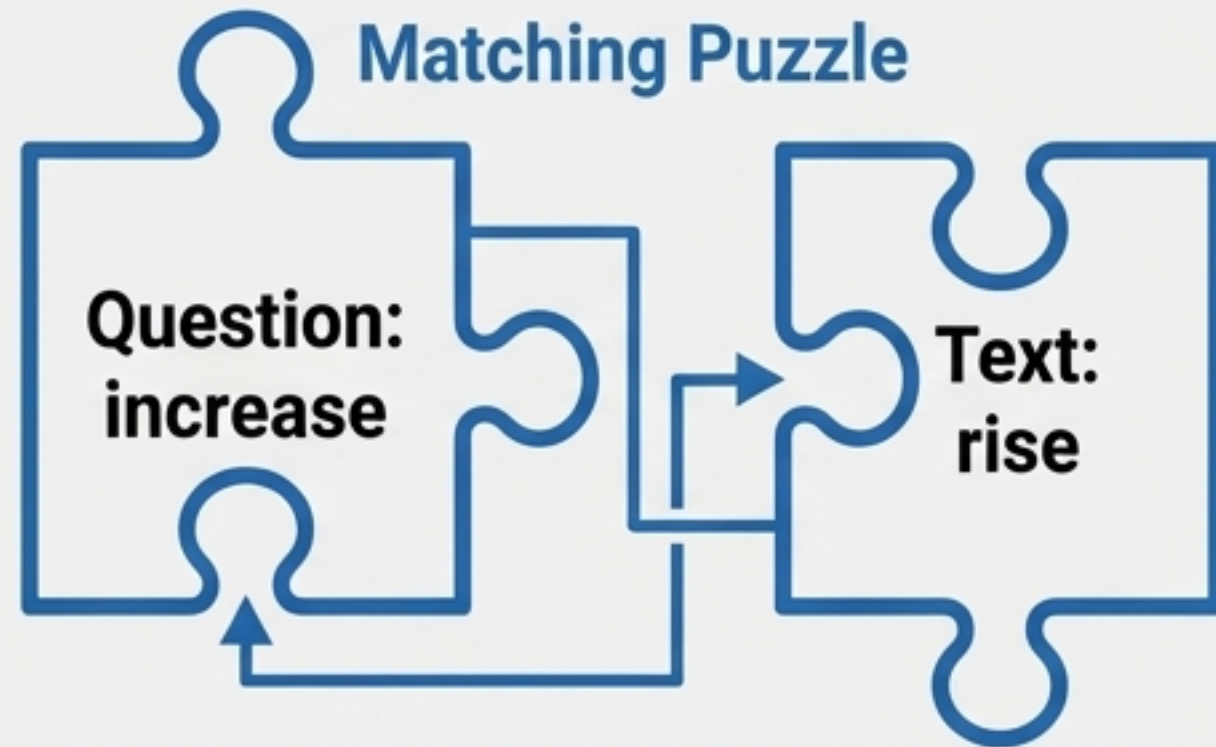
Key Insight

Focuses attention on targeted searching, saving working-memory capacity for processing complex language only in context.

Aligns perfectly with cognitive studies on top IELTS scores.

The Twin Pillars of Paraphrasing & Pacing

Paraphrasing



- **Mapping Words:** Trains the brain to map question nouns and verbs to text synonyms.
- **Transferable Skill:** This core insight drastically boosts Reading, Listening, Writing, and Speaking scores.

Pacing



- **The Reality:** 40 questions in a strict 60-minute window.
- **The Solution:** Guided scanning maximizes the Return on Investment of every minute by preemptively locating answer zones and stopping aimless, drifting re-reading.

Step 1: Skim for the Scaffold (1-2 Minutes)

- **The Goal:** Identify the overall theme, narrative arc, and passage structure.
- **The Action:** Quickly glance at the highlighted elements.

 **The Golden Rule:** Do not read for deep meaning yet!

The Impact of Urbanization on Biodiversity

A Global Perspective on Habitat Fragmentation

Early Studies on City Growth

Research from the 1980s first indicated a significant correlation between the expansion of urban areas and the decline in local species richness.

The research shows an early species richness, including the most common between landscapes and urban areas, which are likely to be associated and highly correlated. A study with the correlation with the important relationship, illustrating the importance of urbanization and how urbanization affects habitat fragmentation.

Modern Challenges and Solutions

Contemporary urban planning models are now attempting to integrate green spaces to mitigate the effects of concrete sprawl.

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Future Projections

Scientists predict that without significant policy changes, the rate of urban-driven extinction will accelerate in the coming decades.

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Teacher Note: Ask the class, "What is the overall theme of this passage? Does it compare two things, or tell a timeline?"

Step 2: Read, Mark, & Predict (3-5 Minutes)

- 1 Read all questions carefully.
- 2 Underline or highlight keywords (focusing specifically on Nouns and Main Verbs).
- 3 Predict the answer type in the margin (Is it a Name? Date? Noun? True/False?).

The Goal

Decode the target before hunting for it.

In what **year** did
the **organization**
establish its
headquarters?

Looking for
a **Date** or
Year!

Step 3: Scan, Read Locally, & Verify

Research from the 1980s first indicated a significant correlation between the expansion of urban areas and the decline in local species richness. Studies in various ecosystems have consistently shown that habitat fragmentation leads to reduced biodiversity. One key finding is that **contemporary urbanization** planning models are attempting to integrate green spaces. The presence of wildlife corridors remains critical for maintaining population viability and genetic exchange.

Sweep the Text

Let your eyes rapidly sweep the paragraphs specifically for your underlined keywords (or their synonyms).

Read Locally

Once found, STOP. Read only that specific nearby sentence closely to extract the exact answer.

Check & Transfer

Ensure an exact grammar match. Double-check absolute constraints like "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS".

Calibrating the Strategy for Target Bands

Band 6.0: Structure & Confidence

Needs step-by-step modeling, collective class skimming (2-3 mins), and dedicated worksheets to physically practice underlining keywords.

Band 6.5–7.0: Autonomy & Accuracy

Needs mild time targets (2 min per question) and group discussions focused on identifying synonyms, prefixes, and suffixes.

Band 7.5+: Extreme Speed

Needs extreme time pressure (1 min skim), practicing answering questions out of order, and identifying subtle cues like double negations.

Teacher Note: Remind students that mastering the form comes before speed. Build accuracy first, then compress the time limit.

Common Execution Traps & Immediate Fixes



Over-reading

Problem: Falling back to reading every word wastes crucial time.

Fix: Praise brevity; enforce strict, unforgiving time limits during drills.



Ignoring Instructions

Problem: Missing strict directives like "ONE WORD ONLY".

Fix: Make physically circling the instruction words a mandatory habit.



Keyword Tunnel Vision

Problem: Matching exact words but completely missing the synonyms.

Fix: Practice paraphrasing exercises and relying heavily on context clues.



The Anxiety Blank

Problem: Leaving questions blank under exam pressure.

Fix: Answer easy questions first to build momentum; guess strategically to eliminate options.

Advanced Pitfalls & Strategy Comparison

Pitfalls

Time Misallocation: Spending **5 minutes** on one hard question ruins overall pacing.

Weak Vocab: Use morphological clues. For example, the suffix **"-tion"** usually signals a noun.

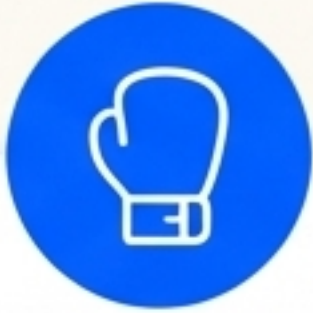
T/F/NG Confusion: **FALSE** is a direct contradiction of the text, not just "missing info".

Teacher Note: Note that Skim/Scan is vastly faster than pure Paragraph Mapping. Don't waste time mapping if the questions are mostly detailed MCQs.

Strategy Comparison Matrix

Strategy	Attributes & Verdict
Where-before-What (Skim + Scan)	Fast global context, targeted search. Verdict: Best Default Method.
Pure Paragraph Mapping	Understands deep flow, but highly time-consuming. Verdict: Best only for Matching Headings.
True/False Tactics	Precise, but high chance of falling into traps if hurried. Verdict: Use specifically for T/F questions.

Micro-Tasks for Building the Muscle



Keyword Boxing (3 min):

Give a paragraph. Box all question **keywords** + **synonyms**.
No answering allowed.



Skim & Summarize (1 min):

Read 1st sentences only. Write a 1-sentence **summary** of the gist.



Speed Scanning (15 sec):

Find the word "**population**" in 5 seconds. Find its **synonym** in 10 seconds.



T/F Mini-Drills (5 min):

Highlight the exact text snippet that actively **proves or disproves** a single standalone statement.

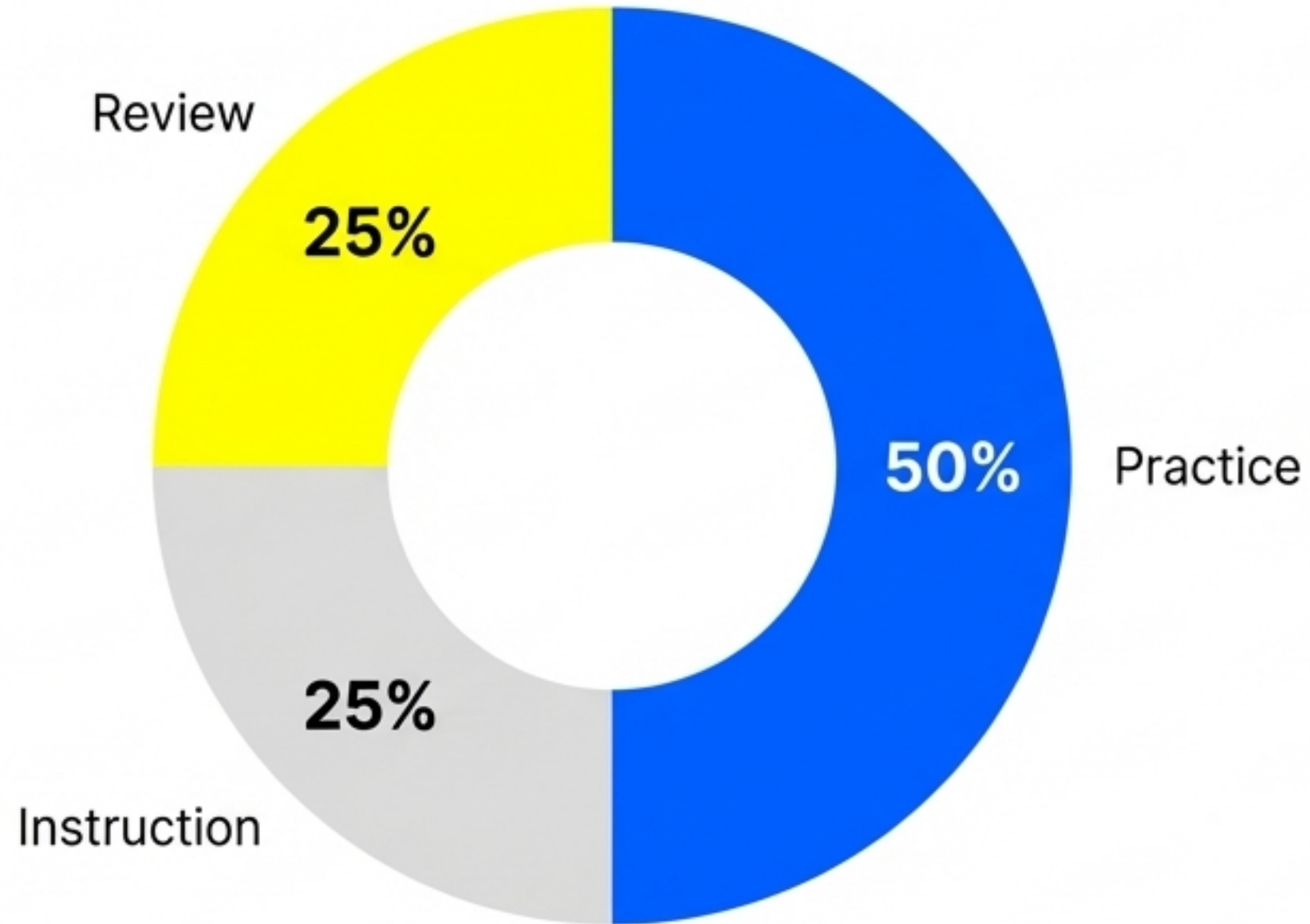


Paraphrase Matching:

Drag-and-drop statements to scrambled text pieces using only **synonym** clues.

Teacher Note: These micro-tasks isolate specific skills. Do one of these as a 5-minute warm-up before any full reading test.

The 60-Minute Masterclass Blueprint



Goal: Track both speed and accuracy.

- **00-05m: Warm-up**
(Brainstorming & concepts)
- **05-15m: Strategy Demo**
(Model the flowchart steps on the board)
- **15-25m: Guided Practice**
(Walk through 4 questions together)
- **25-45m: Timed Test**
(Independent practice, timer running)
- **45-50m: Break**
- **50-60m: Review & Reflection**
(Check answers, ask 'Where was it?')

Teacher Note: Track student improvement by measuring baseline scores vs. practice test scores. Emphasize 'find it, then read it' in the final reflection.